

DQF · auditor export guide

For Acme Trucking LLC · audit window Nov 2025 - Apr 2026

In a safety audit or compliance review, FMCSA investigators pull a sample of driver files and check them against the §391.51 12-document standard. This guide lists what to hand over per driver and the order investigators look at things.

I · PER-DRIVER PULL (FOR EACH SAMPLED DRIVER)

1. Driver's application for employment (§391.21 long-form)
2. Initial MVR (within 30 days of hire) for every state licensed in past 3 years
3. Previous-employer safety performance + D&A inquiries + responses
4. Road test certificate or CDL-on-file equivalent
5. Current medical examiner's certificate
6. NRCME verification date (registry-check documentation)
7. Most recent annual driver review (§391.25(c) signed note)
8. Driver's most recent annual self-certification of violations (§391.27)
9. Annual MVRs for every year of employment
10. Clearinghouse pre-employment full query + driver consent
11. Clearinghouse annual limited query results + general written consent
12. Entry-level driver training (ELDT) certificate (if CDL post-02/07/2022)

II · THE INVESTIGATOR'S TYPICAL REVIEW ORDER

1. **Skim the application** · 3 years of address + 10 years of employment · gaps trigger follow-up questions
2. **Check the medical card** · current? on the NRCME-verified examiner's letterhead? CDLIS status?
3. **Check the MVRs** · annual cadence intact? from every state where licensed?
4. **Check the Clearinghouse trail** · pre-employment + annual limited every year · driver consent documented
5. **Check the annual review** · §391.25(c) note · who reviewed, when, what they found

6. **Cross-reference with roadside inspections** · any violations on roadside not addressed in the file = corrective-action gap
7. **Cross-reference with the Accident Register** · any accidents in §390.15 not reflected in the driver's file = consistency gap

III · AUTO-FAIL FINDINGS (16 IN §385 APPENDIX A)

These come up first in any audit · most are DQF-anchored:

- Driver without a valid CDL (no copy in file)
- Driver with suspended / revoked CDL on the road
- Disqualified driver (§391.15) on the road
- Driver without a current medical card (or expired)
- No pre-employment D&A test
- No random testing program
- No DQ file maintained
- Knowingly using a positive / refused driver

Any single one of these in your driver sample is an automatic conditional rating.

IV · THE X3 COMPASS PER-DRIVER AUDIT PACKET

1. Navigate to **Audit Export** · select scope **DQF**
2. Select drivers (all, sample, or specific list)
3. Click **Generate audit packet** · X3 builds one PDF per driver with all 12 documents in regulatory order
4. Each packet has a version + content hash in the footer · audit-traceable

You don't need every file to be perfect. You need a documented system where issues are caught + corrected. An audit-export bundle that shows "this gap was found Aug 12 + closed Aug 18" beats a clean file with no provenance.